- To check if there is sufficient material for the garment.
- Select suitable method of marking E.g. Tailor's chalk for patterns with cutting lines only, Pencil and carbon paper to mark patterns for beginners, because sewing line can be marked.
- Do not mark using lead pen because it leaves black marks on the pattern.

Tailor's Chalk

- This is one of the easiest and simplest ways of transferring the pattern details on to the fabric.
- Tailor's chalk is a triangle coloured wax available in dark and light colours.
- The pattern is placed in the fabric and the outline is drawn using the chalk.

Pencil and Carbon Paper

- It is the oldest method of marking the patterns where carbon is placed in between the pattern and fabric.
- Then the pattern outline and details are drawn using an ordinary pencil.
- In this technique the sewing line and dart can be transferred.

Tracing Wheel

- A tracing wheel is also known as a pattern wheel, pounce wheel and dart wheel is an instrument with multiple teeth on a wheel attached to a handle. The teeth can be either serrated or smooth. It is used to transfer markings from sewing patterns onto the fabric with or without the use of tracing paper and can be used to make slotted perforations.
- Such markings might include pleats, darts, buttonholes, notches or placement lines for appliqués or pockets.
- The double tracing wheel has two parallel wheels that can be positioned a variable distance apart.
- This tool can be used to transfer parallel pattern lines onto the fabric, such as both the cutting line and the sewing line, where the distance between them is the seam allowance.

8.14 Cutting the Patterns

Cutting is the method of piecing the fabric into suitable sizes, so that it can be sewn together to form a full and neat garment.

Points to Consider

- Before actually start cutting into the fabric, make sure all the pattern pieces are laid out correctly and taken into account that some pieces may need to be cut out twice, or even four times (common with pockets and waistbands with interfacing).
- Extra fabric will need to be purchased when using prints that have a directional pattern, a print that needs to be matched (like with stripes and plaids), and fabric with a directional nap (like with velvet and corduroy). Pay close attention out pattern pieces on fabrics that have a direction.
- Make sure to use pins and scissors that are sharp. Dull pins can be damaging on more delicate fabrics, and sharp scissors make a big difference in the accuracy of cutting. Seams along corners and hemlines are cut in straight lines.
- Use rotary cutter and pattern weights. While cutting around pins. Not only is this method much faster, but it significantly reduces fraying while cutting.

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